
Natural Sugar Body Scrubs

The Complete Guide

30+ homemade recipes • natural colorants • storage & safety • chic packaging • how to sell

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Table of Contents

01	Why Homemade Scrubs Became an Unmissable Beauty Trend	3
02	The Universal Base: Sugar & Coconut Oil	5
03	Fruity Scrubs: Fresh, Colorful and Irresistible	8
04	Floral Scrubs: Elegance, Softness and Spa Spirit	15
05	Gourmand Scrubs: Delicious Scents, Ultra Sellable	22
06	Natural Colorants: Beautiful Colors With Zero Chemicals	28
07	Storage, Shelf Life and Best Practices	30
08	Chic Presentation: A Professional, Irresistible Finish	33
09	How to Sell These Natural Scrubs	35
10	30 Ready-to-Make Recipes	37

How to use this guide: Chapter 2 teaches the universal base method every recipe builds on. Chapters 3 through 5 are organized by scent family, each recipe with exact measurements and numbered steps. Chapters 6 through 9 cover color, safety, packaging and selling. Chapter 10 is a quick-reference index of every recipe in the book.

CHAPTER

01

Why Homemade Scrubs Became an Unmissable Beauty Trend

How a jar of sugar and oil turned into one of the fastest-growing corners of natural beauty — and why it isn't slowing down.

A few years ago, homemade sugar scrubs were a niche hobby. Today they are a full category of their own — sold on Etsy, at craft fairs, in small boutiques, and through thousands of home-based Instagram shops. Understanding why this trend took off will help you make better decisions about your own recipes, your presentation, and how you talk about your products.

The clean beauty shift

Shoppers increasingly want to know exactly what touches their skin. Many mainstream exfoliants use plastic microbeads, which are now restricted or banned outright in several countries because they don't biodegrade and pollute waterways. A sugar scrub is the opposite: every grain dissolves in water, every ingredient can be named on one hand, and the whole jar is genuinely biodegradable. That single fact — no plastic, no mystery chemicals — is the number one reason customers give for switching to a handmade scrub.

Instant gratification, real results

A batch of scrub takes about ten minutes to make and delivers a visible, feel-it-immediately result: smoother skin right after rinsing. That fast feedback loop is part of why the format spreads so well on video — people can show the entire process, start to finish, in a single short clip.

Low cost of entry, real income potential

Unlike most handmade product categories, sugar scrubs need no special equipment, no commercial kitchen, and no big upfront investment. A starter batch of ingredients costs a few dollars and yields several jars. That combination — low cost, fast production, high perceived value — is exactly why this has become a favorite side-income project for stay-at-home parents, retirees, and anyone looking for a flexible way to earn without a storefront or big savings to risk.

Why it sells itself

A finished jar looks and smells like a spa product, but a customer can watch the entire process happen in your hands in real time. That transparency — seeing exactly what goes in — builds more trust than any label ever could.

A gift category, not just a self-care category

Sugar scrubs photograph beautifully, cost little to produce, and feel thoughtful to receive — which makes them one of the easiest handmade products to sell as gifts: birthdays, holidays, teacher appreciation, bridal shower favors, and small thank-you gestures. Repeat, one-off gift buyers are often the easiest customers to win, because they are shopping on feeling rather than comparing prices.

The rest of this guide walks through exactly how to make a wide range of scrubs reliably (Chapters 2 through 6), how to keep them safe and shelf-stable (Chapter 7), how to package them so they look professional (Chapter 8), and how to actually sell them (Chapter 9). By the end, you'll have both the recipes and the small business playbook to go with them.

CHAPTER

02

The Universal Base: Sugar & Coconut Oil

*Master this one method and every recipe in this guide — all 30 of them —
becomes a simple variation on a theme.*

Every sugar scrub in this guide, no matter how it's scented or colored, starts from the exact same two ingredients in the exact same relationship: sugar and coconut oil, at a 2:1 ratio by volume. Learn this base well and you'll never need to follow a recipe rigidly again — you'll be able to invent your own.

The 2:1 ratio, explained

For every 1 cup of sugar, use 1/2 cup of oil. This ratio gives you a scrub that holds together in the jar, spreads easily on wet skin, and doesn't feel greasy or runny. It's a starting point, not a law — your climate, your sugar's grain size, and your oil's temperature will all nudge it slightly. That's normal, and it's exactly what the troubleshooting table below is for.

Symptom	What's happening	Fix
Too dry / crumbly, doesn't hold together	Not enough oil relative to sugar	Add melted coconut oil 1 teaspoon at a time, stirring fully between additions
Too wet / oily, pools liquid at the bottom of the jar	Too much oil, or oil added while too hot and thin	Add sugar 1 tablespoon at a time until it thickens back up
Gritty and uncomfortable on the face	Coarse granulated sugar is too abrasive for facial skin	Swap to caster (superfine) sugar for any face-labeled jar
Separates after a few weeks on the shelf	Normal for oil-based mixtures at room temperature	Stir with a dry spoon before each use — it's cosmetic, not spoiled

Granulated vs. caster sugar

Granulated white sugar is the workhorse for body scrubs — its larger crystals give a satisfying, effective exfoliation on tougher skin (elbows, knees, feet). Caster (superfine) sugar has much smaller crystals and is the better, gentler choice for a facial scrub or for anyone with sensitive skin. Brown sugar sits in between texture-wise and adds a natural caramel note, which is why it appears in most of the gourmand recipes in Chapter 5.

Refined vs. virgin coconut oil

Refined coconut oil is processed to remove scent and taste, which makes it neutral — the right choice whenever you want a fruity, floral, or gourmand fragrance to come through without competing with a coconut smell underneath. Virgin (unrefined) coconut oil keeps its natural tropical aroma and a slightly richer feel, which is ideal for the Fruity Coconut recipe in Chapter 3, or any time you want the coconut note to be part of the final scent on purpose.

Oil substitutes for sensitive skin

- **Olive oil** — heavier and more emollient; a good, affordable choice for very dry skin.
- **Sweet almond oil** — light, slightly nutty, gentle; avoid for customers with tree-nut allergies.

- **Jojoba oil** — chemically closest to skin's own sebum; the top pick for facial scrubs and acne-prone skin, though pricier.
- **Grapeseed oil** — light and fast-absorbing; a good option for oily or combination skin that doesn't want a heavy after-feel.

The base recipe

1 cup granulated sugar • 1/2 cup melted virgin coconut oil • optional 1/4 teaspoon vitamin E oil. Mix sugar first, add oil gradually while stirring, until it looks like wet sand. This exact base is what every other recipe in this guide starts from.

CHAPTER

03

Fruity Scrubs: Fresh, Colorful and Irresistible

Bright, juicy, colorful — fruity scrubs are usually the first jars to sell out at a market table.

Every recipe below follows the universal base from Chapter 2, with its own mix-ins, colorants, and scent. Measurements are exact and steps are numbered so you can follow along without guessing — and once you've made two or three, you'll start recognizing the pattern well enough to improvise your own.

Fruity Strawberry Scrub

Scent notes: sweet, juicy, red berry

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 2 tablespoons freeze-dried strawberry powder
- 5 drops strawberry or red berry fragrance/essential oil
- A pinch of beet root powder (for a deeper pink, optional)

STEPS

1. Prepare the base scrub (sugar + melted coconut oil) following the universal method.
2. Sift the freeze-dried strawberry powder in gradually, stirring between additions to avoid clumps.
3. Add the beet root powder a little at a time if you want a stronger pink — start with 1/8 teaspoon.
4. Once the color is even, stir in the fragrance oil off any heat.
5. Transfer to a jar, smooth the top, and let it set for an hour before sealing.

Tip

Freeze-dried fruit powder (not fresh fruit) keeps this scrub water-free, which is what gives it a 2-3 month shelf life instead of a few days.

Fruity Lemon Scrub

Scent notes: zesty, bright, citrus

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- Zest of 1 organic lemon (dried or freshly grated and patted dry)
- 4 drops lemon essential oil
- 1/8 teaspoon turmeric powder (for a soft yellow tint, optional)

STEPS

1. Make the base scrub and let it cool to just-warm.
2. Stir in the lemon zest, distributing it evenly through the mixture.
3. Add the turmeric powder a pinch at a time, mixing well before adding more — it colors fast.
4. Add the lemon essential oil last, off any heat.
5. Jar it up and label clearly: citrus scrubs increase sun sensitivity (see Chapter 7).

Tip

Citrus oils are photosensitizing. Recommend customers use this scrub in the evening, or apply SPF the next morning on treated skin.

Fruity Peach Scrub

Scent notes: soft, sweet, orchard fruit

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) fine granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon freeze-dried peach powder
- 4 drops peach or apricot fragrance oil
- A pinch of orange-tinted mica or a tiny pinch of paprika (optional, for color only)

STEPS

1. Combine sugar and melted coconut oil into the base mixture.
2. Whisk in the peach powder until the color is uniform pale apricot.
3. If using mica or paprika for color, add in tiny increments — a little goes a long way.
4. Stir in the fragrance oil off heat, mixing thoroughly.
5. Pack into jars and smooth the surface with the back of a spoon for a clean finish.

Tip

Fine sugar (not coarse) suits fruity blends best — it makes the scrub feel plush rather than gritty, which matches the soft peach theme.

Fruity Coconut Scrub

Scent notes: creamy, tropical, warm

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) virgin coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon unsweetened desiccated coconut, finely shredded
- 4 drops coconut fragrance oil

STEPS

1. Build the base scrub with sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Fold in the desiccated coconut for texture and a natural tropical look.
3. Stir in the coconut fragrance oil.
4. Spoon into jars while the mixture is still soft and pourable.
5. Let set at room temperature for 1 hour before capping.

Tip

This is the easiest recipe in the whole collection to batch in bulk — it uses the base almost as-is, which makes it a great starter recipe for beginners.

Fruity Raspberry Scrub

Scent notes: tart, fresh, red fruit

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 1/2 tablespoons freeze-dried raspberry powder
- 4 drops raspberry or mixed-berry fragrance oil

STEPS

1. Prepare the universal base and let it cool slightly.
2. Sift in the raspberry powder in two additions, stirring well each time to avoid seeds clumping.
3. Add the fragrance oil off heat and mix until fully blended.
4. Check the color — it should be a soft rosy pink; add a touch more powder if you want it deeper.
5. Fill jars, tap gently on the counter to remove air pockets, then seal.

Tip

Strain raspberry powder through a fine sieve first — raspberry seeds can feel scratchy on the face, so this scrub works best as a body-only recipe.

Fruity Orange Scrub

Scent notes: sunny, citrus, uplifting

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- Zest of 1 organic orange, dried and finely grated
- 4 drops sweet orange essential oil
- A pinch of orange mica or annatto powder (optional)

STEPS

1. Combine the sugar and melted oil into the base.
2. Mix in the dried orange zest evenly.
3. Add the coloring powder in small increments until the shade you like is reached.
4. Stir in the orange essential oil last.
5. Jar, smooth, and label with a sun-sensitivity note (citrus oils).

Tip

Sweet orange oil is gentler than lemon on sensitive skin, but the same SPF-after-use advice still applies.

Fruity Mango Scrub

Scent notes: lush, tropical, sweet

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) fine granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon freeze-dried mango powder
- 4 drops mango or tropical-fruit fragrance oil
- A pinch of yellow-orange mica (optional)

STEPS

1. Make the base scrub with sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Stir in the mango powder gradually until evenly colored and smooth.
3. Add coloring mica in tiny pinches if you want a bolder tropical shade.
4. Fold in the fragrance oil off heat.
5. Pack into jars, smooth the tops, and let cure for an hour.

Tip

Pair this one visually with a raffia tie and a kraft label for an instant 'tropical getaway' shelf display at markets.

Fruity Watermelon Scrub

Scent notes: light, sweet, summery

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon freeze-dried watermelon powder
- 4 drops watermelon or melon fragrance oil
- A pinch of beet powder for a rosier pink (optional)

STEPS

1. Build the base with sugar and melted oil.
2. Mix in the watermelon powder in two additions.
3. Add a whisper of beet powder if the color needs to be pinker.
4. Stir the fragrance oil in off heat until fully incorporated.
5. Jar, smooth, seal — a lovely lightweight scent for warm-weather markets.

Tip

Watermelon scent fades faster than heavier fruit notes — use slightly more fragrance oil (up to 6 drops) if you want it to stay noticeable in the jar.

Fruity Pineapple Scrub

Scent notes: tangy, tropical, energizing

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon freeze-dried pineapple powder
- 4 drops pineapple or tropical fragrance oil

STEPS

1. Prepare the universal base scrub.
2. Whisk in the pineapple powder until evenly distributed.
3. Add the fragrance oil off heat, stirring thoroughly.
4. Taste-test the scent by warming a small amount between your fingers before jarring the whole batch.
5. Spoon into jars and let firm up before capping.

Tip

Pineapple pairs beautifully with coconut — consider a 'Piña Colada' twist by using half pineapple powder and half desiccated coconut.

Fruity Blueberry Scrub

Scent notes: sweet, slightly tart, cool

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 1/2 tablespoons freeze-dried blueberry powder
- 4 drops blueberry or mixed-berry fragrance oil
- A pinch of butterfly pea flower powder (for a blue-violet tint, optional)

STEPS

1. Combine sugar and melted coconut oil into the base.
2. Sift in the blueberry powder gradually, mixing well.
3. Add butterfly pea flower powder in tiny increments for a deeper blue-violet shade.
4. Stir in the fragrance oil off heat.
5. Fill jars, smooth the tops, and let set for an hour.

Tip

Blueberry powder can stain light countertops — work on a cutting board or silicone mat when making darker fruity scrubs.

Fruity Green Apple Scrub

Scent notes: crisp, clean, green

FRUITY

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon freeze-dried green apple powder
- 4 drops green apple fragrance oil
- A pinch of spirulina or chlorophyll powder (for a soft green tint, optional)

STEPS

1. Make the base scrub with sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Mix in the green apple powder until fully blended.
3. Add spirulina powder a tiny pinch at a time to reach a pale, natural green.
4. Stir the fragrance oil in off heat.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal once set.

Tip

Green scrubs sell especially well bundled as a 'fresh & clean' trio with lemon and pineapple for a citrus-forward gift set.

CHAPTER

04

Floral Scrubs: Elegance, Softness and Spa Spirit

Soft, romantic, and reminiscent of a proper spa visit — floral scrubs are the easiest upsell for a gift-buying customer.

Every recipe below follows the universal base from Chapter 2, with its own mix-ins, colorants, and scent. Measurements are exact and steps are numbered so you can follow along without guessing — and once you've made two or three, you'll start recognizing the pattern well enough to improvise your own.

Floral Rose Scrub

FLORAL

Scent notes: romantic, powdery, classic floral

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) fine granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon dried culinary rose petals, finely crushed
- 4 drops rose essential oil or rose absolute (well diluted)
- A pinch of pink mica or beet powder (optional)

STEPS

1. Prepare the base scrub with sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Crush the dried rose petals into small flecks (not powder) and fold them in.
3. Add coloring in small increments until you reach a soft blush pink.
4. Stir in the rose oil last, off heat — a little goes a long way.
5. Jar, garnish the top with one extra pinch of petals for presentation, and seal.

Tip

Rose is one of the top three best-selling scents in this category — always keep extra dried petals on hand for garnish, they make the jar look boutique-made.

Floral Lavender Scrub

Scent notes: calming, herbal-floral, spa-like

FLORAL

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon dried lavender buds
- 5 drops lavender essential oil
- A pinch of purple mica (optional)

STEPS

1. Make the universal base scrub.
2. Stir in the dried lavender buds, distributing them evenly.
3. Add the mica in tiny increments if you want a visible lilac tone.
4. Add the lavender essential oil off heat and mix thoroughly.
5. Spoon into jars, pressing a few whole buds on top for a spa-shelf look.

Tip

Lavender is calming and safe at low dilution for most skin types, which makes it a very easy first-time recipe to recommend to customers with sensitive skin.

Floral Chamomile Scrub

Scent notes: soft, apple-like, soothing

FLORAL

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon dried chamomile flowers, lightly crushed
- 4 drops chamomile essential oil (German or Roman)
- A pinch of chamomile tea powder for extra golden color (optional)

STEPS

1. Build the base with sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Fold in the crushed chamomile flowers evenly.
3. Add the tea powder a little at a time for a warmer golden tone.
4. Stir in the essential oil last, off heat.
5. Jar and let firm up before sealing — this one is gentle enough to market for sensitive skin.

Tip

Chamomile is one of the calmest essential oils on this list — a good default recommendation for a customer asking for the 'gentlest one you have.'

Floral Hibiscus Scrub

Scent notes: tart-floral, vibrant, exotic

FLORAL

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon dried hibiscus flowers, finely ground
- 1/2 teaspoon hibiscus powder (natural red-pink colorant)
- 4 drops geranium or rose fragrance oil (hibiscus has little scent of its own)

STEPS

1. Prepare the base scrub with sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Sift in the hibiscus powder gradually — it colors quickly and vividly.
3. Fold in the ground dried hibiscus flowers for texture.
4. Add the fragrance oil off heat, since hibiscus alone is nearly scentless.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal once the color is even.

Tip

Hibiscus powder is one of the strongest natural red-pink colorants available — start with 1/4 teaspoon and build up, since a little stains a lot.

Floral Jasmine Scrub

Scent notes: heady, sweet, exotic floral

FLORAL

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) fine granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 4 drops jasmine absolute or fragrance oil (well diluted)
- A pinch of dried jasmine flowers, crushed (optional, for texture)

STEPS

1. Make the universal base scrub.
2. Stir in the crushed dried jasmine flowers if using, for a decorative fleck.
3. Add the jasmine oil off heat — start with 3 drops and test the scent strength before adding more.
4. Mix thoroughly until the fragrance is evenly distributed.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal.

Tip

Jasmine oil is intensely fragrant and expensive — this is a great 'limited batch' or premium-tier jar to price slightly higher than the rest of the line.

Floral Ylang-Ylang Scrub

Scent notes: rich, sweet, tropical floral

FLORAL

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 4 drops ylang-ylang essential oil
- A pinch of yellow mica (optional, ylang-ylang flowers are pale yellow)

STEPS

1. Build the base scrub with sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Add the coloring in a small pinch if desired.
3. Stir in the ylang-ylang oil off heat — its scent is strong, so 4 drops is usually enough.
4. Mix until fully blended.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal.

Tip

Ylang-ylang is considered a natural relaxant scent — market it as an 'evening wind-down' jar alongside lavender.

Floral Geranium Scrub

Scent notes: green, rosy, balanced floral

FLORAL

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 4 drops geranium essential oil
- A pinch of pink mica (optional)

STEPS

1. Make the base scrub.
2. Add the mica in a small pinch for a light pink hue, if desired.
3. Stir in the geranium oil off heat.
4. Mix thoroughly until evenly scented and colored.
5. Jar, smooth, seal.

Tip

Geranium is a great budget-friendly substitute when a customer loves rose scent but the batch cost needs to stay low.

Floral Violet Scrub

Scent notes: powdery, sweet, old-world floral

FLORAL

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) fine granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 4 drops violet or iris fragrance oil
- A pinch of butterfly pea flower powder for a lilac tint (optional)

STEPS

1. Prepare the universal base scrub.
2. Add the butterfly pea flower powder in tiny increments to reach a soft lilac.
3. Stir in the fragrance oil off heat.
4. Mix until color and scent are even throughout.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal.

Tip

Violet is a nostalgic, 'vintage perfume' note — pairs well with elegant packaging like wax seals and ribbon (see Chapter 8).

Floral Orange Blossom Scrub

Scent notes: bright, sweet, honeyed floral

FLORAL

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 4 drops neroli or orange blossom essential oil
- A pinch of orange-tinted mica (optional)

STEPS

1. Make the base scrub with sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Add mica in a small pinch if a soft peach tone is wanted.
3. Stir in the orange blossom oil off heat.
4. Mix until fully incorporated.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal.

Tip

Orange blossom sits between fruity and floral — a good 'bridge' scent to recommend to customers who can't decide between the two categories.

Floral Sweet Pea Scrub

Scent notes: delicate, sweet, garden floral

FLORAL

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) fine granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 4 drops sweet pea fragrance oil
- A pinch of pastel pink or lilac mica (optional)

STEPS

1. Prepare the universal base scrub.
2. Add mica in a small pinch for a pastel tone, if desired.
3. Stir in the fragrance oil off heat.
4. Mix thoroughly.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal.

Tip

Sweet pea has no strong essential-oil source, so a phthalate-free cosmetic fragrance oil is the standard (and perfectly acceptable) choice here.

CHAPTER

05

Gourmand Scrubs: Delicious Scents, Ultra Sellable

Dessert-inspired scents that smell good enough to eat — consistently the highest-repeat-purchase category.

Every recipe below follows the universal base from Chapter 2, with its own mix-ins, colorants, and scent. Measurements are exact and steps are numbered so you can follow along without guessing — and once you've made two or three, you'll start recognizing the pattern well enough to improvise your own.

Gourmand Coffee Scrub

GOURMAND

Scent notes: roasted, bold, energizing

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) brown sugar (for extra richness)
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1/3 cup (35 g) finely ground used or fresh coffee grounds
- 3 drops vanilla or coffee fragrance oil (optional)

STEPS

1. Melt the coconut oil and combine it with the brown sugar to form the base.
2. Stir in the coffee grounds until evenly distributed — the mixture will darken noticeably.
3. Add the fragrance oil off heat if you want to round out the aroma.
4. Mix well, making sure no dry pockets of grounds remain.
5. Jar while soft, tapping to settle, then seal.

Tip

One of the best-selling gourmand scents by far — caffeine scrubs are popular for their reputation of temporarily brightening the look of skin.

Gourmand Chocolate Scrub

Scent notes: rich, sweet, cocoa

GOURMAND

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated or brown sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 2 tablespoons unsweetened cocoa powder
- 4 drops chocolate or vanilla fragrance oil

STEPS

1. Combine sugar and melted coconut oil into the base.
2. Sift in the cocoa powder gradually, stirring to avoid clumps.
3. Add the fragrance oil off heat and mix until the color and scent are even.
4. Check texture — add a touch more oil if the cocoa powder made it feel dry.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal.

Tip

Cocoa powder is also a natural brown colorant — see Chapter 6 for how to use it purely for color in unscented recipes too.

Gourmand Honey & Cinnamon Scrub

Scent notes: warm, spiced, cozy

GOURMAND

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) brown sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 tablespoon raw honey
- 1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon

STEPS

1. Melt the coconut oil and combine with the brown sugar.
2. Warm the honey slightly so it pours easily, then stir it in.
3. Add the cinnamon gradually, tasting the scent as you go — it's potent.
4. Mix until fully combined and glossy.
5. Jar and seal — note that honey-based scrubs should be used within 6-8 weeks for best texture.

Tip

Do not use cinnamon BARK essential oil here — it is a known skin irritant. Ground culinary cinnamon in small quantity is the safe choice (see Chapter 7).

Gourmand Vanilla Scrub

Scent notes: sweet, warm, comforting

GOURMAND

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1 teaspoon pure vanilla extract or 4 drops vanilla fragrance oil
- A pinch of cocoa powder for a warm cream color (optional)

STEPS

1. Make the base scrub with sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Stir in the vanilla extract or fragrance oil off heat.
3. Add a pinch of cocoa powder if a creamier tone is wanted.
4. Mix until fully blended and smooth.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal.

Tip

Vanilla is consistently one of the top three requested scents at craft fairs — keep this one in stock at all times.

Gourmand Brown Sugar Caramel Scrub

Scent notes: buttery, sweet, dessert-like

GOURMAND

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) dark brown sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 4 drops caramel or butterscotch fragrance oil
- 1/4 teaspoon vitamin E oil

STEPS

1. Combine the dark brown sugar with the melted coconut oil.
2. Stir until the mixture takes on a deep caramel color naturally from the sugar.
3. Add the fragrance oil off heat and mix thoroughly.
4. Stir in the vitamin E oil last.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal.

Tip

Dark brown sugar alone gives this scrub its caramel color — no added colorant needed, which keeps the ingredient list short and easy to market as 'simple'.

Gourmand Gingerbread Scrub

Scent notes: spiced, sweet, holiday

GOURMAND

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) brown sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 1/4 teaspoon ground ginger
- 1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- A pinch of ground cloves

STEPS

1. Make the base with brown sugar and melted coconut oil.
2. Add the ginger, cinnamon, and cloves gradually, mixing after each addition.
3. Taste-test the scent strength by warming a bit between your fingers.
4. Mix until fully combined.
5. Jar and seal — a strong seasonal seller from October through December.

Tip

Batch this one in the fall for holiday markets — spiced gourmand scents are the single strongest seasonal sales spike in this whole guide (see Chapter 9).

Gourmand Maple Pecan Scrub

Scent notes: nutty, sweet, autumnal

GOURMAND

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) brown sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) coconut oil, melted
- 4 drops maple fragrance oil
- 1 tablespoon finely ground pecans (patch-test first, tree-nut allergen)

STEPS

1. Combine brown sugar and melted coconut oil into the base.
2. Stir in the ground pecans for texture and nutty aroma.
3. Add the maple fragrance oil off heat.
4. Mix until fully incorporated.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal — label clearly as containing tree nuts.

Tip

Always disclose nut ingredients clearly on the label — this is the one recipe in the guide with a real allergen consideration.

Gourmand Almond Cookie Scrub

GOURMAND

Scent notes: sweet, nutty, bakery-like

INGREDIENTS

- 1 cup (200 g) granulated sugar
- 1/2 cup (110 g) sweet almond oil (instead of coconut oil, for extra nutty scent)
- 4 drops almond fragrance oil
- A pinch of vanilla extract (optional)

STEPS

1. Combine the sugar with the sweet almond oil to form the base (this swap keeps the theme consistent).
2. Stir in the almond fragrance oil off heat.
3. Add a small splash of vanilla extract if desired for a bakery-like finish.
4. Mix until smooth and evenly scented.
5. Jar, smooth, and seal — patch-test recommended (nut-derived oil).

Tip

This is the one recipe in the guide that swaps the oil entirely — a good example to show customers how the base method adapts to other oils.

CHAPTER

06

Natural Colorants: Beautiful Colors With Zero Chemicals

*Every color in this guide comes from a plant, a root, or a mineral — never
a synthetic dye.*

Natural colorants are what turn a plain scrub into something that photographs beautifully and feels intentional. All of them work the same way: add a small amount, stir, look at the color, and add more only if you need it. Powders are far easier to control than liquids or purees — which is also why they keep the scrub water-free and shelf-stable (more on that in Chapter 7).

Colorant	Color produced	Typical amount per 8 oz jar
Beet root powder	Pink to deep red	1/8 to 1/2 teaspoon, added gradually
Turmeric powder	Yellow to golden	A pinch to 1/8 teaspoon — stains fast, use sparingly
Matcha or spirulina powder	Green	1/8 to 1/4 teaspoon
Cocoa powder	Brown	1 to 2 tablespoons (also adds a light chocolate scent)
Activated charcoal	Black / grey	A pinch to 1/8 teaspoon — very concentrated, and drying in excess
Butterfly pea flower powder	Blue to purple	1/8 teaspoon — shifts toward purple/pink with acidic add-ins
Hibiscus powder	Red to magenta	1/8 to 1/4 teaspoon — one of the strongest natural colorants here

The golden rule: add gradually

Every colorant on this list is far more concentrated than it looks. Add a small amount, stir until fully blended, then judge the color under natural light before adding more — melted coconut oil darkens some powders as it cures, so a shade that looks perfect while wet can deepen slightly by the next day.

Avoiding stains

- Work on a silicone mat, cutting board, or covered counter — beet, hibiscus, and turmeric stain light stone and grout.
- Wear gloves when handling concentrated powders directly, especially turmeric and activated charcoal.
- Keep a designated set of mixing spoons and bowls for coloring — the stains build up over time.
- Wipe spills immediately with a damp cloth rather than letting them sit.

No synthetic dyes, ever

None of the recipes in this guide use cosmetic-grade synthetic dyes (FD&C; / D&C; colors). Every color you see in this book comes from a plant, root, or mineral powder — which is also a strong, honest selling point to use in your own product descriptions.

CHAPTER

07

Storage, Shelf Life and Best Practices

These scrubs are naturally shelf-stable — as long as you keep water out of the jar.

Because every recipe in this guide is oil and sugar with no water added, there's very little for bacteria or mold to grow in. That's the single most important safety fact in this whole chapter, and almost every rule below exists to protect that water-free state.

Shelf life

Stored in a sealed jar, out of direct sunlight and away from humidity, a sugar and coconut oil scrub typically stays good for 2 to 3 months at room temperature. Refrigeration is not required and can actually make coconut-oil-based scrubs too hard to scoop. Honey-based recipes (like the Honey & Cinnamon scrub in Chapter 5) are best used within 6 to 8 weeks, since honey is slightly more hygroscopic.

The number one rule: always use a dry spoon

Introducing water into the jar — a wet finger, a damp spoon, steam from a hot shower — is the single most common way a scrub spoils early. Water creates the environment mold and bacteria need. Get in the habit yourself, and remind customers on the label: use a clean, dry spoon or scoop every time.

Vitamin E oil as a natural preservative

Vitamin E oil (tocopherol) is an antioxidant, not an antimicrobial preservative — its real job is slowing down the oil going rancid over time, which extends how long the scrub smells and feels fresh. A standard addition is about 1/4 teaspoon per batch, stirred in last, off any heat.

Patch-testing

Recommend a simple patch test for any new scent, especially for first-time customers: apply a small amount to the inner forearm and wait 24 to 48 hours, checking for redness, itching, or irritation before full use. This is especially worth highlighting for recipes containing nut oils or nut pieces (Chapter 5's Maple Pecan and Almond Cookie scrubs).

Essential oil dilution

Because a scrub covers large areas of skin and is left on briefly during rinsing, keep essential oil concentration low — roughly 3 to 5 drops per 1 1/2 cups of finished scrub is the range used throughout this guide. Oils generally considered safe at this dilution for most adult skin include lavender, chamomile, geranium, ylang-ylang, rose, and sweet orange.

Oils to avoid or use with caution

- **Cinnamon bark essential oil** — a well-known skin irritant; ground culinary cinnamon in small amounts is the safer route (see the Honey & Cinnamon and Gingerbread recipes).
- **Clove, oregano, and cassia essential oils** — strong irritants at cosmetic concentrations; best avoided in leave-on and rinse-off skin products alike.
- **Citrus essential oils** (lemon, lime, bergamot, wild orange) — photosensitizing. Advise customers to use citrus-scented scrubs in the evening, or to apply sunscreen the next time treated skin is exposed to the sun.

Label it clearly

Every jar should note: ingredients, any allergens (nuts), a "patch test before first use" line, and — for any citrus-scented jar — a short sun-sensitivity note. This is good practice and also builds customer trust.

CHAPTER

08

Chic Presentation: A Professional, Irresistible Finish

*The recipe gets someone to buy once. The packaging gets them to buy
again — or give it as a gift they're proud of.*

Two jars with the exact same scrub inside can sell for very different prices, purely based on presentation. Customers are, in part, paying for how the jar makes them feel before they've even opened it.

The jar itself

Clear or lightly frosted glass jars, 4 to 8 ounces, with a wide mouth, are the standard — wide enough to scoop comfortably, small enough to feel like a treat rather than a bulk product. Save square or hexagonal jars for a signature or premium-tier product, since they cost more but stand out immediately on a shelf.

Lids and finishing touches

- **Wooden lids** — the single fastest upgrade from "homemade" to "boutique"; a plain metal lid reads as generic by comparison.
- **Kraft paper labels** — warm, natural, and inexpensive; keep the design simple: product name, scent, net weight, and a short ingredient line.
- **Twine or ribbon** — tie in a color that matches the scent family (blush for florals, natural jute for gourmand, a bright color for fruity).
- **Wax seals** — a small stamped wax seal on the lid, even just an initial, signals handmade craftsmanship instantly and costs very little per jar.

Coordinating by scent family

A simple, repeatable system makes your whole product line look designed rather than improvised: pick one accent color per category (for example, blush pink for floral, warm caramel for gourmand, a bright citrus tone for fruity) and use it consistently across ribbon, label accents, and any tissue paper in a gift box.

The gift-ready test

Before you consider a jar finished, ask: could someone hand this directly to a friend as a gift, with no extra wrapping? If the answer is yes, your packaging is doing its job — and you can charge accordingly.

CHAPTER

09

How to Sell These Natural Scrubs

You don't need a storefront, a business degree, or a big budget — just a consistent, simple system.

Making a beautiful scrub is only half the business. This chapter covers the other half: pricing it sensibly, finding the right places to sell it, and presenting it in a way that converts browsers into buyers.

Pricing psychology

A typical 8-ounce jar costs roughly \$1 to \$2 in raw materials once you account for sugar, oil, colorant, scent, the jar, and basic packaging. Retail pricing in this category commonly lands between \$8 and \$15 per jar — a healthy margin that still reads as fair to the customer, because they're paying for the experience, the packaging, and the natural ingredient story, not just the raw materials.

Bundle sets (three or four scent-family jars together) typically sell at a slight discount to the sum of individual prices, which increases average order size without undercutting your single-jar price point.

Where to sell

- **Instagram and Facebook** — short process videos (pouring, mixing, jarring) consistently outperform static photos; stories and reels are the easiest low-cost way to reach local buyers.
- **Etsy** — built-in search traffic for "natural," "handmade," and "gift" keywords; good for shipping beyond your local area.
- **Local craft fairs and markets** — the single best way to build repeat, local customers who can smell and touch the product before buying.
- **Word of mouth** — don't underestimate it; a jar gifted to a friend is a walking advertisement every time it sits on their bathroom counter.

Simple product photography

You do not need professional equipment. A phone camera and a window with soft, indirect natural light will outperform a flash photo taken in artificial light every time. Shoot near a window in the morning or late afternoon, use a plain background (linen, wood, or a light-colored countertop), and take one close-up texture shot for every product shot — texture is what makes a scrub look genuinely appetizing online.

Batching production

Pick one day a week (or every other week) to make several batches back-to-back, while your labels, jars, and ribbon are already prepped and ready to assemble. Batching this way turns scrub-making from a constant background task into a predictable, scheduled part of your week — and makes it far easier to keep consistent stock across every scent family.

A realistic starting goal

Two jar sales a week, at an average of \$10 to \$12 each, comfortably covers ingredient costs for the next batch and leaves a profit — a small, repeatable loop that's easy to build from.

CHAPTER

10

30 Ready-to-Make Recipes

Every recipe in this guide, at a glance — use it to jump straight to the one you need.

This index lists all 30 recipes from Chapters 2 through 5 in one place, with their scent notes and the page where the full recipe appears.

#	Recipe	Category	Scent Notes	Page
1	The Universal Base Scrub	Base	neutral, warm coconut	5
2	Fruity Strawberry Scrub	Fruity	sweet, juicy, red berry	8
3	Fruity Lemon Scrub	Fruity	zesty, bright, citrus	10
4	Fruity Peach Scrub	Fruity	soft, sweet, orchard fruit	10
5	Fruity Coconut Scrub	Fruity	creamy, tropical, warm	11
6	Fruity Raspberry Scrub	Fruity	tart, fresh, red fruit	11
7	Fruity Orange Scrub	Fruity	sunny, citrus, uplifting	12
8	Fruity Mango Scrub	Fruity	lush, tropical, sweet	12
9	Fruity Watermelon Scrub	Fruity	light, sweet, summery	13
10	Fruity Pineapple Scrub	Fruity	tangy, tropical, energizing	13
11	Fruity Blueberry Scrub	Fruity	sweet, slightly tart, cool	14
12	Fruity Green Apple Scrub	Fruity	crisp, clean, green	14
13	Floral Rose Scrub	Floral	romantic, powdery, classic floral	15
14	Floral Lavender Scrub	Floral	calming, herbal-floral, spa-like	17
15	Floral Chamomile Scrub	Floral	soft, apple-like, soothing	17
16	Floral Hibiscus Scrub	Floral	tart-floral, vibrant, exotic	18
17	Floral Jasmine Scrub	Floral	heady, sweet, exotic floral	18
18	Floral Ylang-Ylang Scrub	Floral	rich, sweet, tropical floral	19
19	Floral Geranium Scrub	Floral	green, rosy, balanced floral	19
20	Floral Violet Scrub	Floral	powdery, sweet, old-world floral	20
21	Floral Orange Blossom Scrub	Floral	bright, sweet, honeyed floral	20
22	Floral Sweet Pea Scrub	Floral	delicate, sweet, garden floral	21
23	Gourmand Coffee Scrub	Gourmand	roasted, bold, energizing	22
24	Gourmand Chocolate Scrub	Gourmand	rich, sweet, cocoa	24
25	Gourmand Honey & Cinnamon Scrub	Gourmand	warm, spiced, cozy	24
26	Gourmand Vanilla Scrub	Gourmand	sweet, warm, comforting	25

#	Recipe	Category	Scent Notes	Page
27	Gourmand Brown Sugar Caramel Scrub	Gourmand	buttery, sweet, dessert-like	25
28	Gourmand Gingerbread Scrub	Gourmand	spiced, sweet, holiday	26
29	Gourmand Maple Pecan Scrub	Gourmand	nutty, sweet, autumnal	26
30	Gourmand Almond Cookie Scrub	Gourmand	sweet, nutty, bakery-like	27

That's 30 distinct, fully-measured recipes in total — 1 base method, 11 fruity, 10 floral, and 8 gourmand. Mix and match colorants from Chapter 6 and packaging ideas from Chapter 8 to turn these into a full, coordinated product line.